



Factory Reset

Honeywell Automation is helping India move towards smarter, connected and autonomous factories

BY PALAK AGARWAL

FOR MANY INDIAN factories, the question is no longer whether to adopt Industry 4.0 technologies, but how to do so without stopping production. Across automotive, electronics and chemicals, manufacturers continue to run decades-old plants while chasing global benchmarks in productivity, quality and sustainability. Honeywell Automation India Ltd (HAIL) is betting on that shift.

Its edge lies in combining automation, software and engineering to help manufacturers modernise without disruption. “Leadership is built on the combined strength of deep technology, disciplined execution, trusted customer partnerships and steady focus on innovation,” says Atul Pai, Managing Director, HAIL, and Vice President & General Manager, Building Automation, Asia (excluding China), Honeywell Technologies, India.

HAIL reported sales turnover of ₹4,190 crore and total assets of ₹4,163 crore, according to Deloitte. It also posted a five-year average return on capital employed of 22% and a negligible debt-equity ratio of 0.02, reflecting a strong balance sheet.

Honeywell Automation favours incremental modernisation. Pai says it uses retrofit-friendly architectures, digital twins and Industrial Internet of Things platforms that allow customers to upgrade plants line by line while operations continue.

Platforms Honeywell Forge and Digital Prime consolidate data from legacy systems, simulate process changes before deployment and lower risk. Pai says this helps manufacturers move “from automation to autonomy.”

The strategy is particularly relevant as India pushes to raise manufacturing’s contribution to GDP to 25% while positioning itself as a global manufacturing hub.

The company also sees India moving beyond manufacturing into innovation. Its engineering teams develop digital twins, industrial software and building automation solutions used globally. It also makes STQC-certified Series 50 security cameras, fire sensors and building management system actuators in India.



Atul Pai,
Managing
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Pai calls this a “Built by India, for the world” approach. Pai says smart manufacturing adoption is strongest in capital-intensive sectors linked to global supply chains, including automotive and electric vehicles, electronics manufacturing services (EMS), chemicals, petrochemicals and life sciences. Pai expects the “factory of 2030” to be connected, AI-enabled and cybersecure.

For Honeywell, the next phase of competitiveness will depend less on replacing factories than on making existing ones intelligent. **BT**

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